

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager II, Payroll Product Activation.*

Positioning, Product manager with 13 years in regulated, infrastructure-heavy domains who compresses complex onboarding workflows into scalable, automation-first product systems.

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Dear Deel Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Product Manager II role on the Payroll Product Activation team. My background is in regulated, infrastructure-heavy product environments, defence AI platforms, public-sector analytics, insurance SaaS, fintech, and the common thread across all of them has been designing systems that handle high customer variation without scaling headcount linearly alongside it.

The specific problem your team describes, compressing a months-long, manual payroll onboarding process into something that runs intelligently across thousands of entities, jurisdictions, and contract configurations, maps directly to work I have done at scale. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS programme, where I had to balance compliance rigour, multinational stakeholder constraints, and a velocity mandate simultaneously. I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD and cut rollout time from days to thirty minutes, and I redirected the product strategy mid-flight when workflow instrumentation showed that the UI-led approach was recording zero real usage. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I drove an ETL modernisation with Dagster and dbt that cut quarterly data-update time by roughly 75%, while simultaneously carrying a full UI relaunch and a container migration. Both engagements required exactly the pragmatic trade-off muscle the posting describes: knowing which problems need perfect solutions and which need "good enough" ones.

I am comfortable owning the full product development lifecycle in high-velocity, ambiguous environments. At CLINET Platforms I inherited a roadmap a five-person team could not deliver, cut it to the 10% of features that moved the agreed success measures, and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. At EMIL Group I rebuilt a fractured 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads, which stopped an engineer exodus and unblocked a Claims Center launch that had no internal precedent. Both situations required making decisions with incomplete information, communicating uncertainty clearly to stakeholders above and below, and course-correcting quickly when reality diverged from the plan.

On the AI and automation side, my daily stack includes Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, and n8n for agentic workflow orchestration. I use these to move faster in discovery and prototyping, and I apply the same LLM-agent design principles to product architecture decisions. The Payroll Product Activation team's stated direction of AI-first, autonomous action on setup workflows is not a direction I am learning toward, it is where I already operate.

I am based in Berlin, an EU citizen with no visa requirement, and fully available for remote work within the EMEA timezone. I would welcome the opportunity to talk through how my experience maps to the specific onboarding automation challenges your team is navigating.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
